On This Day: October 22

Eight events on Oct. 22, from 1797 to 2014 · years ago counted from Oct. 22, 2026 · for classrooms and history buffs

1797 — **First recorded parachute jump** — 229 years ago
André-Jacques Garnerin drops from a balloon over Paris with a silk parachute.

1836 — **Sam Houston takes office in Texas** — 190 years ago
Inaugurated as the first elected president of the Republic of Texas.

1883 — **Metropolitan Opera House opens** — 143 years ago
Opening night in New York City with Gounod's "Faust."

1938 — **First xerographic copy** — 88 years ago
Chester Carlson and Otto Kornei print "10-22-38 ASTORIA" in Queens.

1962 — **JFK's Cuban missile crisis address** — 64 years ago
Kennedy reveals Soviet missile sites in Cuba and a naval quarantine.

1975 — **First photo from the surface of Venus** — 51 years ago
The Soviet lander Venera 9 returns the first image from another planet's surface.

1981 — **Air traffic controllers' union decertified** — 45 years ago
Federal authorities decertify PATCO after its August strike.

2014 — **Attack on Parliament Hill, Ottawa** — 12 years ago
Cpl. Nathan Cirillo is killed at the National War Memorial.

Which event would you research further, and why?

Sources: Texas State Historical Association; American Presidency Project (UC Santa Barbara); The Henry Ford; American Physical Society; NASA; Guinness World Records; EBSCO Research Starters; The Canadian Encyclopedia.